

Tuesday, 11 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Mostly clear 26° 18°	BIRMINGHAM Clear 29° 15°	MANCHESTER Overcast 29° 16°	GLASGOW Overcast 24° 13°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

A new weight loss pill has been approved for use here in the UK, offering another option in the fight against obesity.

Called Foundayo, it's made by Eli Lilly, the same pharmaceutical firm behind the popular Mounjaro injection. This could be a significant development for many people.

HEALTH · UK
- 2

Counter-terrorism police have reopened an inquiry into an incident at Reform UK leader Nigel Farage's home.

Mr Farage claims the incident is directly linked to the murder of former politician Ann Widdecombe. It's a serious development in an ongoing investigation.

POLITICS · UK
- 3

Thames Water has given its new finance boss a staggering one million pound signing-on fee.

Steve Buck received the seven-figure payment as part of a package to persuade him to join the troubled utility company. It's certainly raised some eyebrows given the company's recent issues.

BUSINESS · UK
- 4

Tragic news from Camber Sands beach, where an 18-year-old man has died after getting into difficulty in the sea.

Sussex Police were called to the popular beach just before 7pm on Sunday. Our thoughts are with his family and friends.

TRAGEDY · UK
- 5

Dramatic footage has captured the moment a bungalow was destroyed in an explosion, thought to have been caused by a gas leak.

The video also shows the home burning fiercely after the blast. Thankfully, it's believed no one was seriously injured.

INCIDENT · UK

What's coming up

1

Olympic gold medallist Tabby Stoecker is officially joining the star-studded line-up for this year's Strictly Come Dancing!

The Team GB skeleton racer said she was 'over the moon' to be hitting the dancefloor. We can't wait to see her in sequins!

ON AIR – Do you think her Olympic discipline will give her an edge on the dancefloor?

TV · AUTUMN

2

Legendary Italian tenor Andrea Bocelli is set to perform in Wales for the first time in 22 years!

He'll be gracing the Principality Stadium in Cardiff in May 2027. Fans will be thrilled to hear his incredible voice live once again.

ON AIR – Who would you love to see perform in Wales after a long break?

MUSIC · 2027

3

A 'spectacular' Game of Thrones stage spin-off has opened at the home of Shakespeare, receiving rave reviews!

Most theatre critics are calling it a worthy addition to the epic fantasy franchise. Sounds like a must-see for fans!

ON AIR – Are you excited to see Game of Thrones brought to life on stage?

THEATRE · NOW

4

Harry Potter fans have successfully forced the diversion of a major UK-Ireland power link to avoid Dobby's grave!

Fans complained after a project manager suggested cables would go under the beloved character's resting place. It just shows the power of a dedicated fanbase!

ON AIR – What lengths have you gone to for your favourite fictional character or story?

FILM · NOW

5

Rising singer Kamal has opened up about the 'scary' moment he reached out to superstar Dave for his debut album.

The London-based musician is aiming for 'honesty' within his new record. It's always great to hear new artists making their mark.

ON AIR – Who is your favourite new music artist right now?

MUSIC · NOW

On the schedule

1 Hibs have stunned Rangers with a dramatic late winner at Ibrox, keeping Derek McInnes waiting for his first win as Rangers manager.

Callum Wright's goal secured a big victory for Hibernian. It was a thrilling match for the fans!

ON AIR – What's the most dramatic late goal you've ever seen in a game?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 Aston Villa are reportedly in talks to sign Bayern Munich midfielder Joao Palhinha.

This would be a significant move for Villa as they look to strengthen their squad. It's always exciting to see big names linked with Premier League clubs.

ON AIR – Do you think Palhinha would be a good fit for Aston Villa?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 England cricket hopeful Emilio Gay will undergo further treatment this week on a shoulder injury.

The opener is hoping to be fit for the first Test against Pakistan. Fingers crossed he makes a speedy recovery!

ON AIR – How crucial do you think Emilio Gay is to England's Test plans?

CRICKET · UK

4 Kasper Høgh's hat-trick has fired Celtic to an emphatic Scottish Premiership victory over Kilmarnock!

It was a dominant performance from Celtic, with Høgh clearly on top form. A great result for the team!

ON AIR – How important is a hat-trick for a striker's confidence at the start of the season?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 Demi Vollering has shown her incredible prowess, winning the final stage to clinch her second Tour de France Femmes title!

She's now the first two-time winner of the race. A truly remarkable achievement in the world of cycling!

ON AIR – Who is your favourite female athlete making headlines right now?

CYCLING · GLOBAL

Quick hits

- 1 The simple act of 'doodling during meetings' is now being championed as a way to boost concentration and memory.**
Far from being a sign of inattention, researchers suggest that a bit of scribbling can help keep your mind engaged, preventing boredom and improving recall of information.
- 2 A charming new trend sees people 'swapping favourite tea blends' with friends and neighbours.**
It's a lovely way to discover new flavours and share a bit of warmth, creating a delightful sense of community over a cuppa.
- 3 The unexpected joy of 'revisiting childhood playgrounds' as an adult is gaining traction.**
Many are finding a nostalgic delight in seeing how their old haunts have changed, and sometimes even having a quick go on the swings!
- 4 Experts are suggesting that 'spending time observing local wildlife' in your garden can significantly reduce stress.**
Even just watching birds at a feeder or squirrels scampering about can provide a calming escape from daily worries.
- 5 The surprising appeal of 'collecting old cinema tickets and programmes' is captivating film enthusiasts.**
It's a wonderful way to preserve personal memories of films enjoyed and provides a tangible link to cinema history.
- 6 A new study indicates that 'the sound of distant church bells' can evoke feelings of peace and nostalgia for many.**
Regardless of faith, the gentle chimes often remind people of simpler times and a sense of quiet community.
- 7 The delightful resurgence of 'homemade picnic baskets' for day trips is making outdoor eating more charming than ever.**
People are enjoying the creativity of packing personalised treats, making every al fresco meal feel extra special.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to put our shoes on in a hurry, even if it's not the most dignified approach?

ANSWER: WOBBLING ON ONE LEG WHILE BALANCING AGAINST A WALL OR FURNITURE.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down with a good book. What is it?

ANSWER: ADJUSTING ALL THE CUSHIONS ON THE SOFA PERFECTLY, EVEN IF THEY WERE ALREADY FINE.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you discover a 'secret shortcut' that saves you just a tiny bit of time or effort in your daily routine?**
What's that little genius shortcut or hack you've found that you simply couldn't live without now, even if it's only a few seconds saved?

- **We all have those 'comforting smells' that instantly take us back to a happy memory, don't we?**
What's that one particular smell that, whenever you catch a whiff of it, immediately transports you to a wonderful moment or memory from your past?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that a group of owls is actually called a 'parliament'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The Northern Lights can make a distinct crackling sound, like static electricity, that can sometimes be heard on very quiet nights.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still perfectly edible.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, specifically one hundredth of a second.
- The world's oldest known living tree is a bristlecone pine named 'Methuselah', estimated to be over 4,800 years old, located in California.
- Bananas are technically berries, while strawberries are not.
- It is impossible for most people to lick their own elbow.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.
- The dot over the lower-case 'i' and 'j' is called a 'tittle'.

On this day

Day 223 of the year, 142 days left in 2026. Today Christian Feast Day: Athracht; Christian Feast Day: Clare of Assisi; Christian Feast Day: Gaugericus; Christian Feast Day: John Henry Newman (Church of England). Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1997 — Sarah Clelland, Scottish footballer
- 1965 — Embeth Davidtz, American actress
- 1954 — Joe Jackson, English singer-songwriter and musician
- 1941 — John Ellison, American-Canadian musician and songwriter
- 1958 — Jah Wobble, English singer-songwriter and bass player
- 1942 — Mike Hugg, English drummer and keyboard player
- 1968 — Sophie Okonedo, British actress
- 1985 — Asher Roth, American rapper

THE DAY TODAY

- 1952 — Hussein bin Talal is proclaimed King of Jordan.
- 1975 — East Timor: Governor Mário Lemos Pires of Portuguese Timor abandons the capital Dili, following a coup by the Timorese Democratic Union (UDT) and the outbreak of civil war between UDT and Fretilin.
- 2003 — NATO takes over command of the peacekeeping force in Afghanistan, marking its first major operation outside Europe in its 54-year-history.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1965 — Race riots (the Watts Riots) begin in the Watts area of Los Angeles, California.
- 1995 — The Russell Hill subway accident in Toronto kills 3 and injures 30, due to a combination of human error and a safety system design flaw.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1984 — "We begin bombing in five minutes": United States President Ronald Reagan, while running for re-election, jokes while preparing to make his weekly Saturday address on National Public Radio.

1942 — Actress Hedy Lamarr and composer George Antheil receive a patent for a Frequency-hopping spread spectrum communication system that later became the basis for modern technologies in wireless telephones, two-way radio communications, and Wi-Fi.

- 2012 — At least 306 people are killed and 3,000 others injured in a pair of earthquakes near Tabriz, Iran.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 224 of the year, 141 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Euplius; Christian feast day: Eusebius of Milan; Christian feast day: Herculanius of Brescia; Christian feast day: Pope Innocent XI. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1972 — Mark Kinsella, Irish footballer and manager
- 1992 — Cara Delevingne, English model and actress
- 1963 — Sir Mix-a-Lot, American rapper, producer, and actor
- 1966 — Tobias Ellwood, American-English captain and politician
- 1961 — Roy Hay, English guitarist, keyboard player, and composer
- 1971 — Yvette Nicole Brown, American actress, comedian, and talk show host
- 1954 — Sam J. Jones, American actor
- 1985 — Danny Graham, English footballer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1964 — South Africa is banned from the Olympic Games due to the country's racist policies.
- 1981 — The IBM Personal Computer is released.
- 1960 — Echo 1A, NASA's first successful communications satellite, is launched.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1948 — Between 15 and 150 unarmed members of the Khudai Khidmatgar movement are killed by Pakistani police.
- 1977 — The Sri Lanka Riots: Targeting the minority Sri Lankan Tamils, begin, less than a month after the United National Party came to power. Over 300 Tamils are killed.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

SAT 15 Premier League season begins (2026/27)

22–23 Belgian Grand Prix (F1)